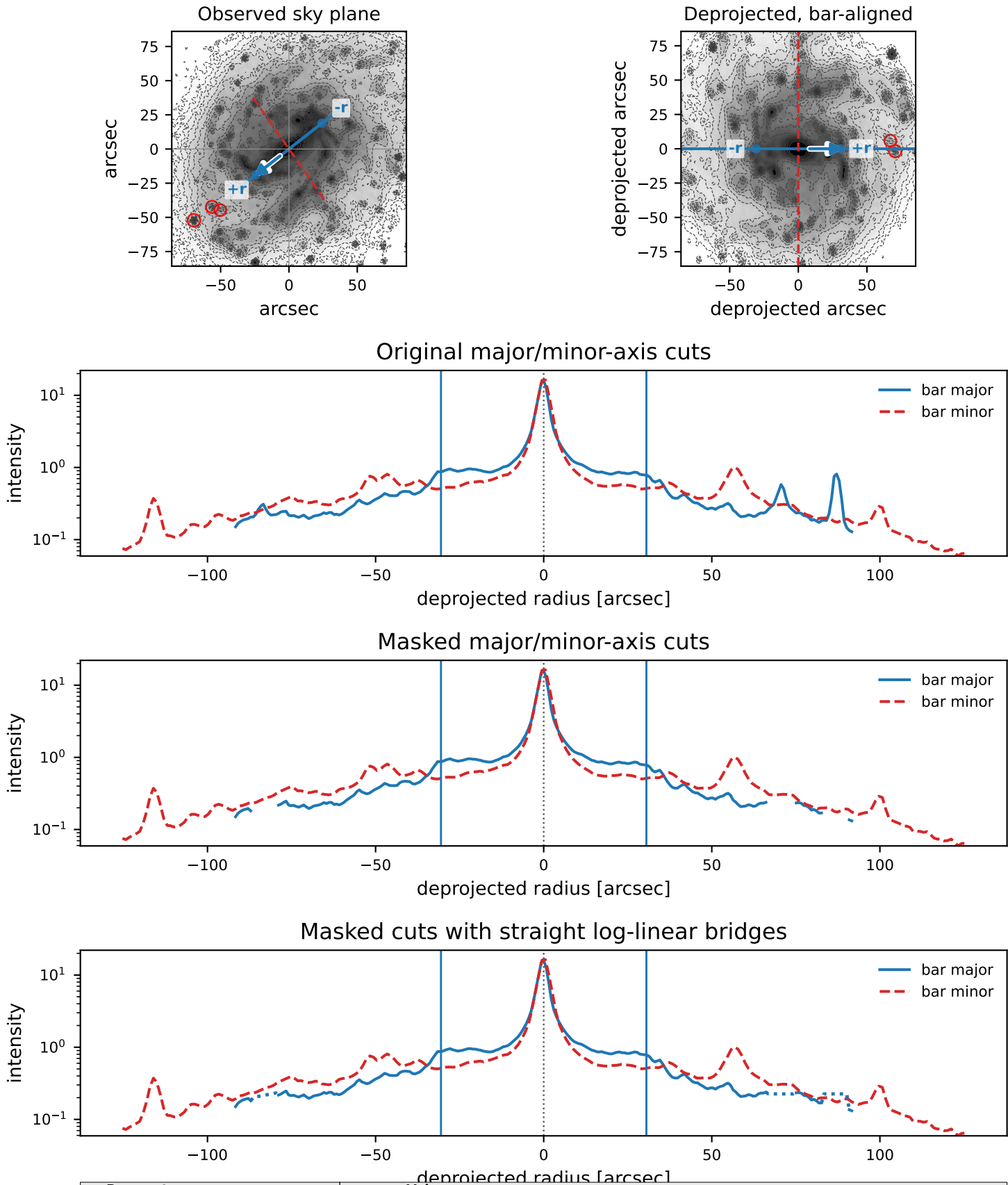


NGC7418 bar-spike-gated foreground-candidate profile comparison bar PA=128.0 deg



Original major/minor-axis cuts

Masked major/minor-axis cuts

Masked cuts with straight log-linear bridges

Parameter	Value
Masking model	spike-gated; photutils segmentation on residual image; photutils 3.0.0
Residual image	science image - Gaussian-smoothed galaxy model
Detection threshold	4.5 sigma above residual median
Profile spike gate	15 bar-major spike samples
Spike rule	peak >= 25% above 4-15 arcsec neighbours; >= 40% above +/-3 samples; r >= 8 arcsec
Smooth sigma	15 px
Connected-pixel minimum	8 px
Dilation radius	3 px
Max segment area	500 px
Max elongation	6
Central exclusion radius	12 px
Profile width	3 px
Applied mask	5 source segments; 503 pixels ignored
Filled-profile panel	solid=measured data; fine dotted=samples filled by straight log-intensity bridge
Bridge merge gap	12 profile samples
Auto-tune grid	5, 4.5 sigma; selected 4.5 sigma